# Paul Skenes

RHP · PIT · 2026 · 2,890 pitches

**Family 1–: Low slot, runs under**

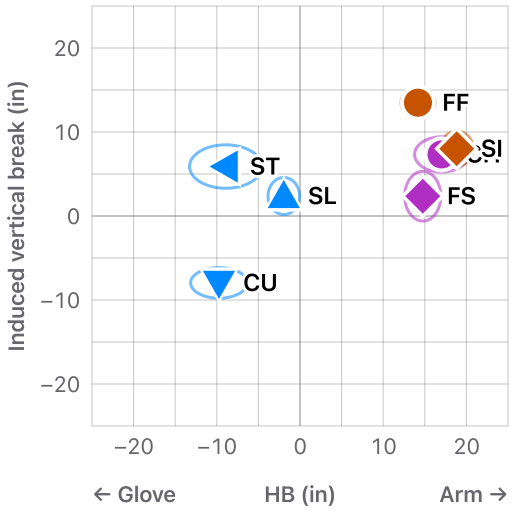
1– | 25° Slot | 95% Efficiency | −5° Tilt | 22 BU Spin

Low slot, runs under  Reference: Four-seam

1:45

Low slot (27°) with a four-seam that runs under the slot (−6°), spun very cleanly (97% efficient), with low spin for its velocity (22 BU).

## Arsenal Movement




Averages with one-standard-deviation ovals. Drawn from behind the pitcher: arm side is to the right.

## Top Recommendations

- ● Slider: Ceiling 126, now 109 (gap +17). The best reachable shape is −1.0 in IVB and 11.0 in glove side. Main lever: grip / seam orientation. The seam effect is in the 33rd percentile of comps who throw it. Confidence: High (21 comps).
- ● Four-seam: Ceiling 101, now 96 (gap +5). The best reachable shape is 14.0 in IVB and 16.0 in arm side. Main lever: grip / seam orientation. The seam effect is in the 48th percentile of comps who throw it. Confidence: High (25 comps).
- ◐ Changeup: Ceiling 118, now 90 (gap +28). The best reachable shape is −2.0 in IVB and 19.0 in arm side. Main lever: spin rate on this pitch. Confidence: Medium (14 comps).

## Top Five Comps

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Drew Carlton (2023) | 1 \| 25/100/−5/23 | 93 |
| Nathan Eovaldi (2022) | 2 \| 30/100/−5/22 | 90 |
| Joe Kelly (2024) | 1 \| 25/95/−5/22 | 90 |
| JP Sears (2025) | 2 \| 30/100/−5/22 | 89 |
| Steven Brault (2021) | 1– \| 25/95/−5/23 | 89 |

## Every Pitch: Today and Potential

| Pitch | Usage | Velo | Spin | IVB | HB | Stuff+ | Ceiling | Gap | Main Lever | Conf. |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Four-seam** | 41% | 96.8 | 2176 | 13.5 | 14.2 | 96 | 101 | +5 | Grip / Seam Orientation | ● |
| **Sweeper** | 16% | 84.3 | 2333 | 5.9 | −8.9 | 110 | 124 | +13 | Grip / Seam Orientation | ○ |
| **Changeup** | 12% | 88.7 | 1821 | 7.3 | 17.0 | 90 | 118 | +28 | Spin Rate on This Pitch | ◐ |
| **Sinker** | 12% | 96.6 | 2154 | 8.0 | 18.8 | 105 | 114 | +9 | Grip / Seam Orientation | ◐ |
| **Splitter** | 10% | 93.2 | 1638 | 2.4 | 14.8 | 111 | 126 | +15 | Grip / Seam Orientation | ○ |
| **Slider** | 9% | 86.7 | 2317 | 2.4 | −1.9 | 109 | 126 | +17 | Grip / Seam Orientation | ● |
| **Curveball** | <1% | 81.8 | 2422 | −8.0 | −9.7 | 103 | — | — | — | — |

Velocity in mph, spin in rpm, movement in inches (IVB: induced vertical break; HB: horizontal break from behind the pitcher, arm side positive).

## Confidence and Data Notes

Stuff+ is Spin ID's own model, not FanGraphs Stuff+. 100 is the 2021–2024 average pitch. Ceiling: what this pitcher's comps do with each pitch, at this pitcher's own velocity and release; Gap is Ceiling minus today; the lever is the change that adds the most. Fastballs keep their natural spin.

Confidence (● High, ◐ Medium, ○ Low) is how much real MLB data sits behind each estimate. Estimates, not promises.

Validity test T5 passed: Stuff+ in 2025 lined up with 2026 results at r = 0.21, better than velocity alone (0.09) and 2025 results (0.09), over 1,247 pitches.

Tested (T4, 2025 to 2026): bigger gaps came with only slightly bigger next-season Stuff+ gains (partial r 0.07; the range includes zero), so treat a gap as a direction to explore, not a forecast.

2026 season: 2,889 pitches with a pitch type; the Spin ID comes from 1,180 four-seams. Comps are the nearest Spin IDs (slot, efficiency, tilt offset, spin) among MLB pitcher-seasons 2021–2026.